

Bed Capacity Management Procedure

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Purpose

This procedure supports management of hospital bed capacity and patient flow during operational pressure.

Capacity pressure may be indicated by high bed occupancy, limited available beds, delayed transfers, non-criteria-to-reside patients, discharge delays or increasing emergency demand.

Site and operational teams should review current occupancy, expected admissions, planned discharges, delayed discharge barriers and available escalation capacity.

Actions may include discharge coordination, use of approved escalation capacity, review of elective activity, cross-site coordination and escalation to senior operational leadership where pressure remains high.

Bed capacity actions should be reviewed throughout the day and recorded through normal operational governance arrangements.